VOL4

VOLUME 4

Group Dynamics & Social Activities

80 engaging group activities for ball games, music, reminiscence, and team challenges.

80 Activities | 4 Sections | Group Format | All Abilities

SENIOR ACTIVITY VAULT · PROFESSIONAL EDITION



SECTION 1

Seated Ball Games

Balloon keep-up, pass-the-ball variations, target throws, and parachute games that energise groups while being accessible to all mobility levels.

- Balloon and foam ball games
- Target and bowling activities
- Parachute group games
- Cup stack and relay





Balloon Keep-Up

★ Independent

Keep a balloon airborne as a group by tapping it to each other.

1. Arrange chairs in a circle; give one balloon.
2. Tap balloon upward or to a neighbour.
3. Count consecutive taps without floor contact.
4. Try to beat your group record each session.



Medicine Ball Pass

★ Independent

Pass a light ball around the circle without dropping it.

1. Sit in circle; pass a soft ball to the right.
2. On signal, reverse direction.
3. Increase speed with each round.
4. Try passing with non-dominant hand.



Colour Target Throw

★★ Assisted

Throw beanbags to a coloured target called by the facilitator.

1. Set three coloured circles in front of group.
2. Facilitator calls a colour.
3. Each player throws their beanbag to that colour.
4. Score 1 for direct hits; tally group total.



Sitting Volleyball

★★ Assisted

Hit a balloon over a rope strung between chairs.

1. Tie a rope between two chairs at head height.
2. Divide into two teams either side.
3. Tap balloon over rope; if it drops, other team scores.
4. First to 10 points wins.



Roll-a-Ball Bowling

★ Independent

Roll a ball along the floor to knock down plastic bottles.

1. Set 5 bottles in a triangle 2 metres from players.
2. Each player rolls ball to knock down pins.
3. Record score; reset pins after each turn.
4. Play 5 frames; highest score wins.



Catch and Name

★ Independent

Throw a ball to a group member and call their name to practise names and coordination.

1. Stand or sit in circle with one ball.
2. Call a group member's name; toss the ball to them.
3. They must catch, then call and toss to someone else.
4. Continue 5 minutes; no repeating names until all called.



Over-Under Pass

★ Independent

Pass a ball alternately over the head and under the legs down the row.

1. Sit in a row of chairs.
2. First player passes ball overhead to second.
3. Second passes under legs to third.
4. Alternate over-under to end; time the run.



Skittle Noodle

★★ Assisted

Use a pool noodle to bat a ball and knock over skittles.

1. Set 5 skittles on a table 1.5 m away.
2. Players take turns hitting a ball with pool noodle.
3. Count skittles knocked; reset after each turn.
4. Highest group total wins.



Parachute Ball Balance

★★ Assisted

Keep a ball moving on a parachute without it falling off.

1. Group holds parachute edges.
2. Place a foam ball in centre.
3. Ripple parachute to keep ball moving but on surface.
4. If ball falls, restart; aim for 2 minutes.



Balloon Tennis

★ Independent

Bat a balloon across a table with paper-plate paddles.

1. Make paddles from paper plates.
2. Two players on each side of table.
3. Hit balloon over a book-spine net.
4. Score 1 per pass; play to 15.



Quoit Toss

★ Independent

Toss rubber rings onto a target post to practise accuracy.

1. Place a post in the centre of the group.
2. Each player receives 3 quoits.
3. Take turns tossing quoits onto post.
4. Score 1 per ringer; tally group total.



Noodle Ring Pass

★ Independent

Pass a hoop along the row using only pool noodles, no hands.

1. Each player holds a pool noodle.
2. Pass a hoop from noodle to noodle down the row.
3. If hoop drops, restart from that player.
4. Time how quickly the group can pass it to the end.



Kick Ball Seated

★ Independent

Kick a large foam ball across the floor using feet while seated.

1. Sit in circle; place large foam ball in centre.
2. Players kick the ball around the circle.
3. On signal, kick hard to a named person.
4. Continue 5 minutes.



Cup Stack Relay

★★ Assisted

Stack plastic cups in a pyramid and collapse them as a relay team.

1. Set 10 cups in front of each team.
2. First player stacks into pyramid; tags next.
3. Next player collapses it; tags next.
4. Continue until all players have stacked and collapsed.



Bocce Ball

★ Independent

Roll balls to land closest to the pallino target ball.

1. Set pallino ball 2 metres away.
2. Each player rolls 2 bocce balls toward pallino.
3. Measure which ball is closest.
4. Team with most balls closest to pallino scores.



Toss and Clap

★ Independent

Clap a set number of times while a balloon is in the air then catch it.

1. Stand or sit; toss balloon high.
2. Clap 3 times before catching.
3. Increase claps each round.
4. Out if balloon touches floor.



Newspaper Roll Ball

★ Independent

Roll a ball made from scrunched newspaper to a target using hands.

1. Scrunch newspaper into a ball.
2. Sit 1 metre from a box.
3. Roll newspaper ball into box.
4. 5 attempts; score = balls in box.



Table Tennis Balloon

★★ Assisted

Use small paddles at a table to volley a balloon over a raised divider.

1. Place a book upright as net on table.
2. Two players bat balloon over book.
3. If balloon hits table on own side, point to other.
4. Play to 10 points.



Four-Corner Ball

★★ Assisted

Pass a ball across a square of 4 players to practise rapid reaction passing.

1. Arrange four chairs in a square 2 metres apart.
2. Pass ball diagonally to the opposite player.
3. Vary passes: high, low, fast, slow.
4. Count passes in 1 minute.



Scoop Ball

★★ Assisted

Use a cut-bottle scoop to catch and launch a ball to a partner.

1. Make scoops from cut plastic bottles.
2. Partners sit 1.5 m apart.
3. Scoop ball into scoop, fling to partner.
4. Count successful exchanges.



SECTION 2

Music & Movement

Chair dancing, rhythm clapping, sing-alongs, music bingo, and drumming circles that use music to boost mood and coordination.

- Chair dancing and freeze
- Rhythm and clapping patterns
- Sing-along and karaoke
- Drumming and songwriting



Chair Dancing

★ Independent

Move arms, torso, and legs to upbeat music while seated for joyful exercise.

1. Put on lively music at 100–120 bpm.
2. Begin with arm swings side to side with the beat.
3. Add shoulder shimmies and leg lifts.
4. Dance for the length of one full song.

Rhythm Clapping

★ Independent

Clap along to music patterns to build rhythmic awareness and coordination.

1. Choose a song with a clear beat.
2. Clap on each beat for 1 minute.
3. Clap on every other beat.
4. Try syncopated patterns (off-beat clapping).

Sing-Along Session

★ Independent

Sing familiar songs together to lift mood and practise breath control.

1. Choose 3 well-known songs from participants' era.
2. Lead the first verse; invite group to join.
3. Use lyric sheets in large print.
4. End with everyone's favourite song.

Music Bingo

★ Independent

Identify song titles from short clips to practise music memory.

1. Prepare bingo cards with song titles.
2. Play a 10-second clip of each song.
3. Participants cross off the title if on their card.
4. First to complete a row calls 'Bingo!'.

Freeze Dance

★★ Assisted

Dance while music plays and freeze completely when it stops.

1. Play music; group moves arms and body.
2. Stop music randomly; all freeze.
3. Last to freeze sits down (or just for fun).
4. Restart music; continue for 5 rounds.

Air Instrument

★ Independent

Play along to a favourite song on an imaginary instrument.

1. Each person chooses an imaginary instrument.
2. Play recording of a favourite song.
3. Everyone plays their air instrument enthusiastically.
4. Switch instruments for the second song.



Name That Tune

★ Independent

Guess song titles from the first few notes to stimulate music memory.

1. Play 5–10 seconds of song intro.
2. First to call out correct title earns a point.
3. Play 20 songs; tally individual or team scores.
4. Award a small prize for the winner.



Drumming Circle

★ Independent

Drum together on hand drums or table tops to build shared rhythm.

1. Each person has a hand drum or upturned bowl.
2. Leader begins a simple 4-beat pattern.
3. Group joins in one by one.
4. Vary tempo and volume; end with a crescendo.

Musical Scarves

★ Independent

Wave coloured scarves in time to music to encourage expressive movement.

1. Give each participant a coloured scarf.
2. Play slow music; wave scarf gently.
3. Play fast music; shake and twirl scarf.
4. Create patterns: figure-eight, overhead, side-to-side.

Decade Playlist Discussion

★ Independent

Listen to music from each participant's favourite decade and share memories.

1. Play 30 seconds of a hit from the 1950s, 60s, 70s, 80s.
2. Ask who recognises it.
3. Invite a brief memory share about that song or time.
4. Build a group playlist of favourites.

Clap and Pass

★ Independent

Clap twice and pass to the next person in time to a beat.

1. Sit in circle; play steady music.
2. First person claps twice, points to next.
3. That person claps twice, points on.
4. If timing is off, start the rhythm again.

Body Percussion

★ Independent

Create a rhythm using taps on various body parts to build body-music connection.

1. Leader demonstrates: pat knees twice, clap twice, snap once.
2. Group copies.
3. Add layers: stomp, chest tap, thigh slap.
4. Combine all layers for a group groove.

Lip Sync Battle

★ Independent

Perform a lip-sync to a favourite song for fun and expressive engagement.

1. Participants choose a favourite song in advance.
2. Play the song; volunteer lip-syncs and acts it out.
3. Group votes for most expressive performance.
4. Everyone gets a turn.

Musical Warm-Up

★ Independent

Guide a full-body seated warm-up choreographed to an upbeat song.

1. Choose a 3-minute upbeat song.
2. March with the beat for the verse.
3. Add arm circles on the chorus.
4. Shoulder rolls and neck tilts in final verse.



Songwriting Circle

★★ Assisted

Create a simple verse together using a familiar melody.

1. Choose a simple tune everyone knows.
2. Ask group for a topic: garden, seaside, family.
3. Each person contributes one line.
4. Sing the finished song together.



Mood Match Music

★ Independent

Listen to pieces of different moods and discuss how the music makes you feel.

1. Play 1 minute of classical, jazz, folk, and pop.
2. After each, ask: how did that make you feel?
3. Discuss: which memories did it trigger?
4. Vote for the group's favourite.

Conductor Game

★ Independent

One person conducts the group's humming, controlling speed and volume.

1. Group hums a simple tune.
2. Conductor raises hands to increase volume.
3. Lowering hands decreases it.
4. Speed up and slow down gestures change tempo.

Rhythm Echo

★ Independent

Leader claps a rhythm and the group echoes it back precisely.

1. Leader claps a 4-beat pattern.
2. Group echoes back.
3. Increase complexity each round.
4. Individual members take turns leading.

Movement Storytelling

★ Independent

Act out a story with arm and body movements set to background music.

1. Facilitator reads a short nature story.
2. Group uses arms and body to depict events.
3. E.g. rain: wiggle fingers down; sun: arms spread wide.
4. Group can suggest new story scenes.

Karaoke Favourites

★ Independent

Sing along to karaoke versions of group favourites using large-print lyrics.

1. Select 3–5 songs voted on by group.
2. Display large-print lyrics or play karaoke video.
3. Encourage everyone to join in.
4. Applaud each performance warmly.



SECTION 3

Reminiscence

Photo discussions, object sharing, decade trivia, and life story prompts that connect participants with meaningful memories.

- Photo and object sharing
- Decade trivia and music
- Life story and mapping
- Cultural and sensory cues





Old Photo Discussion

★ Independent

Share photographs from past decades and discuss stories they bring to mind.

1. Bring a box of old public-domain photos (decades, jobs, places).
2. Pass photos around the circle.
3. Ask: what year might this be? What do you see?
4. Invite personal stories prompted by the images.



Object Sharing

★ Independent

Pass around a familiar old object and invite memories it evokes.

1. Bring one old object: a vinyl record, ration book, old coin.
2. Pass the object around the circle.
3. Each person says one thing it reminds them of.
4. Allow discussion to flow naturally.



Decade Trivia

★ Independent

Answer trivia questions about events from the participants' prime decades.

1. Prepare 20 questions from the 1950s–1980s.
2. Ask questions one by one.
3. Participants call out answers or discuss.
4. Award a point for first correct answer.



Life Story Prompts

★ Independent

Use prompt cards to invite participants to share a story from their past.

1. Prepare cards with prompts: 'my first job', 'a summer holiday'.
2. Draw a card; pass to a volunteer.
3. Volunteer shares 2–3 minutes.
4. Group asks one friendly follow-up question.



Then and Now

★ Independent

Compare how everyday things (phones, shops, TV) have changed over a lifetime.

1. Show a photo of an old object and a modern version.
2. Ask: how did you use the old one?
3. Discuss what changed and what was better then or now.
4. Round table: best change and most missed thing.



Favourite Recipe Share

★ Independent

Share a childhood recipe from memory and discuss food traditions.

1. Ask each person to think of a childhood dish.
2. Take turns describing ingredients and method.
3. Discuss where they learned to cook it.
4. Compile a group recipe card.



Music Memory

★ Independent

Play old songs and discuss what events or places they bring back.

1. Play 10 seconds of 5 songs from the participants' youth.
2. After each, ask what it reminds them of.
3. Invite one story per song.
4. End with the most popular song playing in full.



Childhood Games

★ Independent

Recall and describe games played in childhood to reconnect with joyful memories.

1. Ask: what games did you play in the street?
2. List games on a board (hopscotch, conkers, marbles).
3. Vote for most popular.
4. Discuss the rules of one game in detail.



First Job Stories

★ Independent

Share memories of first working experiences, wages, and colleagues.

1. Ask each person: what was your first job?
2. What did you earn per week?
3. What was your boss like?
4. Share one funny or memorable moment from that job.



School Days

★ Independent

Recall school memories including subjects, teachers, and schoolyard life.

1. Ask: what was your school like?
2. What was your favourite subject?
3. Describe a memorable teacher.
4. Compare then-and-now school experiences.



Map My Life

★ Independent

Sketch or name the places you have lived and discuss what each meant.

1. Give each person a blank paper.
2. Ask them to mark 3–5 places they lived or loved.
3. Share map with group.
4. Tell one story about each place.



Household Chores Then

★ Independent

Discuss how household chores were done before modern appliances.

1. Ask: how did you wash clothes before a machine?
2. Discuss: ironing, preserving food, heating the home.
3. Compare to today's methods.
4. What was hardest? What do you miss?



Holiday Memories

★ Independent

Share best holiday or travel memories from life.

1. Ask each person: best holiday ever?
2. Where did you go, who with?
3. What made it memorable?
4. Pick a group favourite to discuss in detail.



Fashion Through Decades

★ Independent

Discuss fashion trends from different decades using photos or descriptions.

1. Show photos of fashion from 1950s–1990s.
2. Ask: did you wear anything like this?
3. Discuss: favourite clothing item they owned.
4. What trend do they wish would come back?



Transport Then and Now

★ Independent

Recall how people got around before cars and modern transport.

1. Ask: how did you travel to school or work?
2. Discuss: trams, bicycles, horse-drawn carts, first cars.
3. Show old transport photos.
4. Favourite journey memory?



Wartime or Rationing Stories

★ Independent

Share experiences of wartime, rationing, or post-war life if applicable.

1. Ask those who lived through wartime to share one memory.
2. Discuss: what was rationed? How did families manage?
3. How did community feel different?
4. What was the most valuable skill from that time?

📺

Favourite Film or TV Show

★ Independent

Discuss beloved television programmes or films from the participants' era.

1. Ask: favourite TV show growing up?
2. What time did you watch it?
3. Did the family gather?
4. Name one programme you wish still existed.

💍

Wedding Memory

★ Independent

Share memories of weddings: their own or memorable ones they attended.

1. Ask: tell us about your wedding or a wedding you attended.
2. What was the bride/groom wearing?
3. What food was served?
4. What was the funniest moment?

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Smells from the Past

★ Independent

Use scented items to trigger reminiscence through smell.

1. Pass around scented items: lavender, bread, cinnamon, mint.
2. Ask: what does this smell remind you of?
3. Allow 1–2 minutes per scent.
4. Which smell evoked the strongest memory?

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Proud Moment Share

★ Independent

Each person shares the proudest moment of their life.

1. Introduce topic: today we share our proudest moment.
2. Allow 30 seconds of silent reflection.
3. Each person shares in 1–2 minutes.
4. Group applauds after each share.



SECTION 4

Team Challenges

Relay games, cooperative puzzles, group storytelling, and creative challenges that build teamwork and social connection.

- Cooperative puzzles and towers
- Team trivia and bingo
- Storytelling and mimes
- Parachute and group art



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Human Knot

★★ Assisted

Untangle a group human knot without letting go of hands to build teamwork.

1. Stand in circle; reach across to hold two different people's hands.
2. Without releasing, untangle the knot.
3. Work together, stepping over arms and ducking under.
4. Success = a circle or two linked circles.

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Group Jigsaw Puzzle

★ Independent

Complete a large-piece jigsaw puzzle together to practise cooperative problem-solving.

1. Provide a large-piece 50–100 piece jigsaw.
2. Each person picks up and places one piece at a time.
3. Take turns; no individual can dominate.
4. Complete the puzzle; photograph and display.



Relay Word Game

★ Independent

Build a sentence word by word around the circle at speed.

1. Facilitator starts a sentence with one word.
2. Each person adds one word that makes sense.
3. Aim for a silly but grammatical sentence.
4. Play 10 rounds; vary starting words.



Group Storytelling

★ Independent

Create a story together by each person adding one sentence.

1. Facilitator begins: 'Once upon a time there was a...'
2. Next person adds one sentence.
3. Continue around the circle.
4. End with everyone suggesting the last line.



Scavenger Hunt

★★ Assisted

Find items matching a list around the activity room as a team.

1. Prepare a list of 10 items to find in the room.
2. Teams of 3 work together.
3. First team to collect all items wins.
4. Debrief: which was hardest to find?



Team Trivia

★ Independent

Compete in mixed-topic trivia as teams to build friendly competition.

1. Divide into two teams.
2. Ask 20 questions across topics: history, nature, entertainment.
3. Teams discuss and agree on an answer.
4. Score 1 per correct answer; highest total wins.



Cooperative Parachute Wave

★★ Assisted

Create various waves and movements with a parachute requiring group synchronisation.

1. Each person holds the parachute edge.
2. On count, all raise together to make a mushroom.
3. Lower and make gentle waves.
4. Try: popcorn (shake fast), igloo (raise and step under).



Human Bingo

★ Independent

Find group members who match descriptions on your bingo card to encourage socialising.

1. Each participant receives a bingo card with descriptions: 'born in summer', 'has a pet'.
2. Walk around and find people who match.
3. Write their name in the matching square.
4. First to complete a row wins.



Newspaper Tower

★★ Assisted

Build the tallest freestanding tower possible using only newspaper and tape.

1. Give each team 5 sheets of newspaper and 30 cm tape.
2. Teams have 5 minutes to build tallest tower.
3. Tower must stand unsupported for 10 seconds.
4. Measure heights; celebrate creativity.



Chinese Whispers

★ Independent

Whisper a sentence down the chain and compare result to the original.

1. First person receives a written sentence to whisper.
2. Whisper once only to the next person.
3. Final person says aloud what they heard.
4. Compare to original; discuss what changed.



Blindfold Guidance

★★ Assisted

Guide a blindfolded partner through a short course using verbal instructions only.

1. Partner A is blindfolded; B stands 1 metre away.
2. B gives verbal directions: 'two steps forward, turn right'.
3. Guide through a simple cone course.
4. Swap roles; discuss communication strategies.



Team Card Castle

★★ Assisted

Build a freestanding card structure together within 5 minutes.

1. Give two teams one deck of cards each.
2. Build the tallest or most creative structure.
3. No folding; lean only.
4. Award points for height and creativity.



Group Art Mural

★ Independent

Each person contributes one section of a large collaborative art piece.

1. Tape a large paper sheet to the wall.
2. Divide paper into sections; one per person.
3. Each decorates their section freely.
4. Connect sections to form one mural; display it.



Countdown Clap

★ Independent

Clap in unison while counting backward from 20 to practise group synchronisation.

1. Group counts aloud from 20 in unison.
2. Clap on each even number.
3. Gradually increase speed.
4. Try whispering the count and only clapping.



Two Truths and a Lie

★ Independent

Share three statements about yourself; group guesses which is the lie.

1. Each person thinks of 2 true and 1 false statement about themselves.
2. Share all three without revealing the lie.
3. Group votes on which is the lie.
4. Reveal; continue until all have shared.



Team Obstacle Build

★★ Assisted

Teams design a small obstacle course for each other using available room equipment.

1. Teams of 3 set up 3–4 obstacles using chairs, cones, etc.
2. Teams swap courses.
3. Navigate the other team's course.
4. Discuss: which was hardest?

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Group Memory Chain

★ Independent

Build a memory chain where each person repeats all previous items and adds one.

1. First person names an item, e.g. 'apple'.
2. Second person says 'apple, chair'.
3. Continue, each repeating the chain and adding.
4. Game ends when someone forgets; restart.

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Pass the Action

★ Independent

Pass an imaginary object around the circle, miming its properties.

1. Facilitator starts with an imaginary ball; mimes tossing it.
2. Next person catches it (mime) and transforms it into something else.
3. Pass around circle; each transforms the object.
4. Aim for 10 transformations.



Geography Relay

★ Independent

Name cities, rivers, or countries in alphabetical relay to practise geography memory.

1. Choose a category: cities of the world.
2. First person names a city starting with A.
3. Next names one starting with B.
4. Continue to Z; restart from A if someone gets stuck.



Group Mime Scenes

★ Independent

Act out a scene together without speaking, each adding to the shared narrative.

1. Facilitator sets a scene: 'You are on a cruise ship'.
2. Group begins miming; add objects and events.
3. Facilitator adds plot twists: 'storm coming'.
4. End with a group mime finale.